Design Pillars — Ages 18 to 24

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Game Design Pillars

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Part 3 - Ages 18 to 24

Cover 4 Pillars of Development

Each Pillar:

1. Explain the pillar. - 1 Paragraph (Content/Length 5 points - Content/Focus 5 points)

2. How does this pillar impact game design or UX. 1 paragraph (Content/Length 5 points - Content/Focus 5 points)

3. How can we use this pillar in publishing/marketing/BI. 1 paragraph (Content/Length 5 points - Content/Focus 5 points)

- Each student will do this for 4 pillars covered in lecture. (4 pillars x 3 paragraphs is a minimum of 12 paragraphs).

- Maximum points is 30 x 4 = 120 points

Pillar 1: Identity status

Identity status refers to an individual's sense of self and their level of commitment to their beliefs, values, and goals. For young adults in the 18-24 age range, identity formation is a critical developmental task, and they may be exploring different identity options and possibilities before committing to a particular identity. It is important for them to have opportunities for self-discovery and exploration in order to develop a strong sense of identity and purpose.

Understanding identity formation in young adults can inform game design by providing opportunities for players to explore different identities and experiences. Games can offer a safe space for young adults to experiment with different roles and identities, and to make choices that reflect their values and beliefs. Games that incorporate branching narratives or multiple endings can allow players to experience the consequences of their choices and help them develop a stronger sense of their own identity and values. Games that incorporate diverse characters and perspectives can also expose players to a range of identity options and help them develop empathy and understanding for others. Overall, game designers can use an understanding of identity formation to create experiences that promote self-discovery and reflection in young adults. In publishing, marketing, and business intelligence, understanding identity formation in young adults can inform content creation and advertising strategies. By appealing to the values and beliefs of different identity statuses, publishers and marketers can create content that resonates with their target audience and fosters a sense of connection and belonging. By analyzing demographic data and consumer behavior patterns, businesses can identify trends in identity formation and tailor their products and services to meet the needs and preferences of different groups. Incorporating diverse perspectives and representation can also promote inclusivity and help businesses build stronger relationships with their customers. Overall, an understanding of identity status can help inform more effective strategies for engaging with young adults in various industries.

Pillar 2: Identity Confusion

Identity confusion, also known as identity crisis, is a common experience during the period of emerging adulthood, typically between the ages of 18 and 24. This is a time when individuals are exploring and experimenting with different roles, values, and beliefs as they seek to form a coherent sense of self. Identity confusion can manifest as feelings of uncertainty, anxiety, and a lack of direction or purpose. This can lead to difficulties in making decisions and commitments and can impact relationships and overall well-being. However, experiencing and resolving identity confusion can ultimately lead to greater self-awareness, a stronger sense of identity, and increased psychological resilience.

Identity confusion can have an impact on game design, particularly for games targeted at young adults. Games that offer players the opportunity to experiment with different identities and explore different paths can be especially appealing to individuals in this stage of life. Games that offer choices and consequences that reflect different values and beliefs can help players clarify their own identities and build confidence in their decision-making abilities. Additionally, games that feature diverse and relatable characters and storylines can help players feel seen and understood and may offer a sense of validation and support as they navigate the challenges of identity formation. Overall, game design that incorporates themes and experiences related to identity confusion can provide a valuable source of support and self-exploration for young adults.

In publishing, marketing, and business intelligence, understanding the concept of identity confusion in young adults can be useful for creating products and messaging that resonate with this demographic. Marketing campaigns that feature relatable characters and storylines can help young adults feel seen and understood and can build brand loyalty. Publishers can produce content that explores different identities and life paths, helping readers navigate this stage of life. Business intelligence can be used to analyze the behavior and preferences of young adult consumers and tailor products and services to meet their needs. Overall, incorporating an understanding of identity confusion can help companies better connect with and serve the young adult demographic

Pillar 3: Role Experimentation Role experimentation is a stage of mental development that typically occurs in late adolescence and early adulthood, around ages 18-24. During this stage, individuals explore different identities and roles in various domains of life, such as work, relationships, and values. This exploration helps young adults clarify their personal identity and establish a sense of purpose. Role experimentation can involve trying out different jobs, hobbies, lifestyles, and relationships, as well as questioning and reevaluating one's beliefs and values. This process can be challenging and uncertain, but it can also be an exciting opportunity for growth and self-discovery.

Role experimentation can impact game design in several ways. Games that provide players with a range of choices and outcomes, such as open-world or branching narrative games, can simulate the process of exploring different roles and identities. Games that allow players to customize their avatars or characters can also facilitate role experimentation by providing a space to try on different appearances and abilities. Additionally, games that incorporate themes of personal growth and self-discovery, such as overcoming challenges and discovering new strengths, can resonate with players who are going through a similar process in their own lives. By creating games that reflect the challenges and opportunities of role experimentation, game designers can appeal to the interests and needs of young adults in this developmental stage.

Role experimentation is a critical stage in the development of identity for individuals aged 18-24, as they explore various roles and potential identities. In game design, this can be incorporated by allowing players to create and experiment with different character identities within the game. In publishing and marketing, this can be used to target this age group by creating content that highlights the exploration of different identities and roles, such as stories that follow characters on a journey of self-discovery. In business intelligence, understanding this stage can inform the development of training and professional development programs that allow for role experimentation and career exploration. By acknowledging and supporting this stage, individuals can develop a stronger sense of identity and direction in their personal and professional lives.

Pillar 4: Ethnic identity

Ethnic identity refers to the sense of belonging and connection to one's cultural heritage and background. For individuals in the age group of 18-24, exploring and developing their ethnic identity can be an important part of their psychological and social development. This may involve exploring cultural traditions, beliefs, and practices, as well as navigating the challenges and opportunities of being part of a diverse society. Developing a strong sense of ethnic identity can promote self-esteem, positive social relationships, and a sense of purpose and meaning. It may also involve grappling with issues of discrimination, marginalization, and social justice.

Ethnic identity can impact game design by influencing the representation and portrayal of diverse characters, themes, and storylines within games. Game designers can consider incorporating cultural references and symbols that resonate with different ethnic groups to make their games more inclusive and relatable to a wider audience. Additionally, they can also ensure that their games do not rely on stereotypes or harmful tropes that may perpetuate negative stereotypes and biases. By incorporating diverse perspectives and promoting cultural understanding, game designers can create more meaningful and engaging experiences for players of different ethnic backgrounds.

Ethnic identity is an important aspect of an individual's identity formation process during young adulthood. It refers to the sense of belonging and identification with a particular ethnic or cultural group. In publishing and marketing, it is important to consider the diversity of the target audience and ensure that representation and inclusivity are prioritized in content creation. BI can use this pillar to gather data on the ethnic demographics of their target audience and tailor their strategies accordingly. Additionally, businesses can collaborate with diverse content creators and influencers to promote their products and services to a wider range of ethnic groups. Overall, acknowledging and celebrating diversity can be a valuable tool for businesses to connect with their target audience and foster a sense of community.